

General Support, Timber Support

26/08/2019

Requirement of Support I

Supports depends on followings

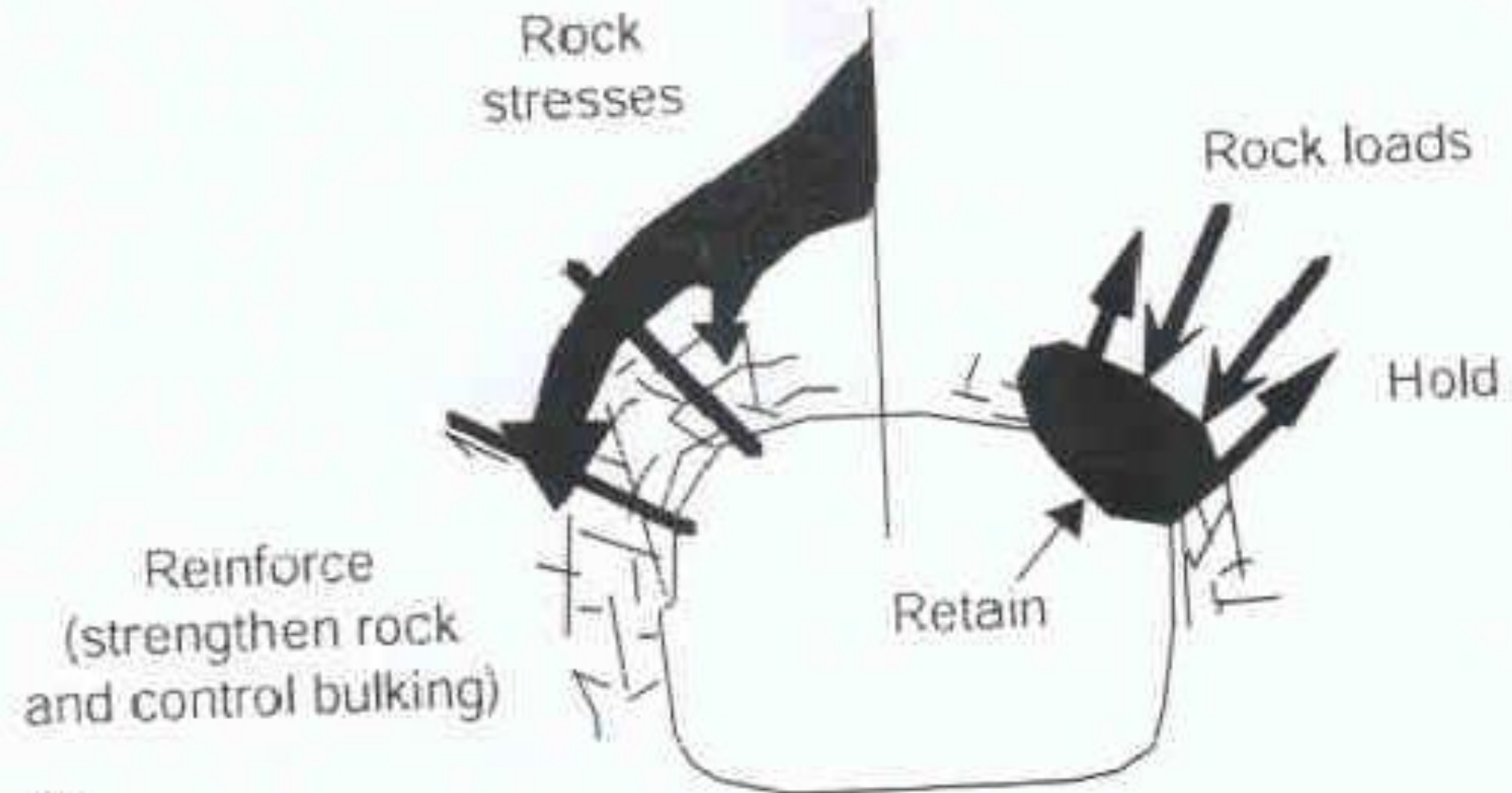
- *Depth
- *Local geological structure (tectonics)
- *Weathering
- *Presence of water
- *Physical & Mechanical properties of rock.
- *Bedding condition.
- *Dimension of excavation
- *Method of excavation.

Design of Support

- *Direction & magnitude of rock pressure.
- *Strength of rock around road ways & tunnel.
- *Life span of opening.
- *Joint plane / bedding plan
- *Stress state of rock mass.
- *Mechanical properties of rock.
- *Shape, dimension & location of excavation.
- *Support work as reinforcement (strengthening rock & control bulking).
- *Holding & retaining rock mass.

Design Of Support I

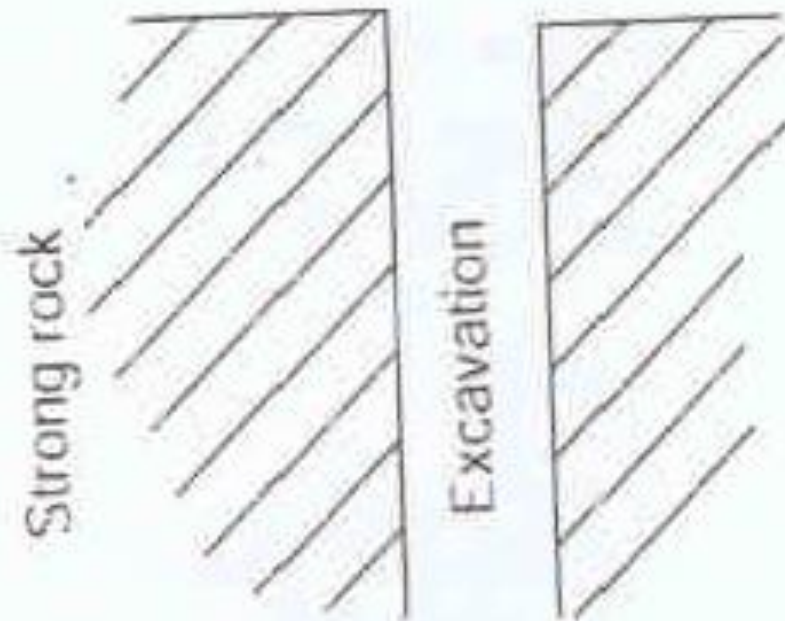
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(i)

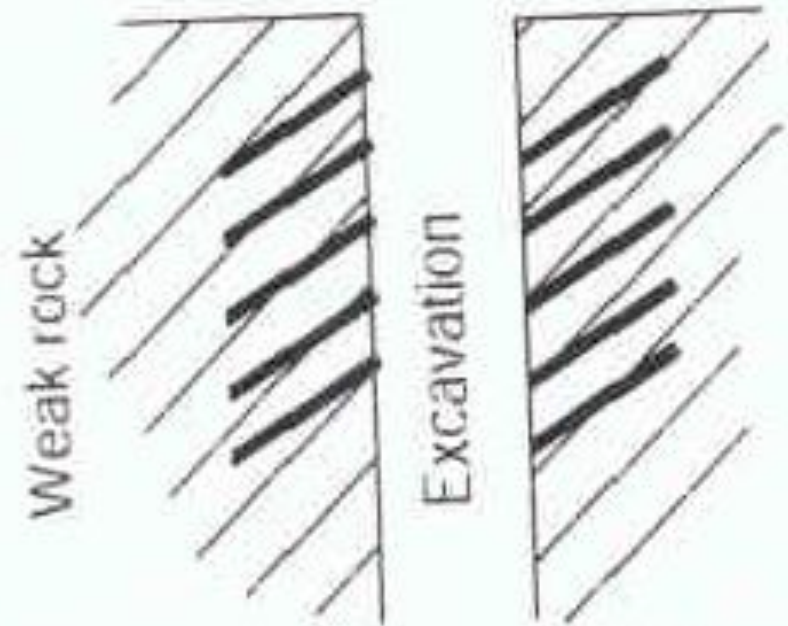
Support Design I

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No support required

(ii) Single set of discontinuities in strong rock



Specific support required
rock bolts oriented with
respect to discontinuities

(iii) Single set of discontinuities in weak rock

Importance of Support

- *Support determine safety of work.
- *Support effect production cost.
- *Support reduces dilution & losses.
- *Support effects intensity of mining & productivity of mines.
- *Element of rock pressure (stress field) in surrounding rock, pillars & artificial support constitute a support net work in mines.

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Self Support By In Situ Rock

- *Excavation design should utilize, in situ rock as much as possible as support.
- *Excavation method should not set loose rock & reduce its strength.
- *Proper excavation shape to be selected, so that excavation should be self supported as much as practical.
- *Blasting method should be so selected, that back & side wall does not get effected / deteriorate.
- *Size of excavation should not be unnecessarily large, demanding artificial support.

Support by Natural Pillars I

- *Microwave heating can fragment hard rock.
- *It can also weaken rock to improve performance of other mining method or secondary breaking.
- *Micro wave can penetrate rock.
- *Electro magnetic energy is converted by rapid vibration of molecules at a location (hot Spot inside the rock).
- *Hot rock then expands according to its specific thermal expansion.
- *Surrounding cool rock does not expand.

Rock (Natural Pillar) I

- *Pillars are left in mine workings are made of in situ or waste rock.
- *Thesis pillars are rigid & does not yield.
- *Board & Pillar, Room & Pillar, Post Pillar are mining method with rock pillars to maintain stability of stope.
- *Ore pillars may be left for ever or can be recovered after wards.
- *Protective pillars are left to protect shaft (shaft pillar) or some other important mine structure in underground

Rock (Natural Pillar) II

- *Level pillars are left to protect main levels, driver, cross cut etc.
- *Crown pillars are left to protect upper level of stope & top part of stope.
- *Sill pillars are left to protect lower level & bottom part of stope.
- *Rib pillar / Block Pillar / Side Pillar are left to protect two adjacent stope & blocks.
- *Support with ore pillar is simple & easy to do.
- *Ore pillar causes loss of ore & inefficient mining work.

Rock (Natural Pillar) III

- *Support design should consider minimum ore loss in pillar.
- *Mining method should allow recovery of ore pillars at end of working.

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Artificial Support I

- *Artificial supports are mine support made from support material brought from surface or other part of mines.
- *Artificial supports are required to maintain stability of mine development & stope.
- *Artificial support plays very important role in systematic support plan for mine development & stoping.
- *Role of artificial support is reduced in caving method.
- *Support holds loose rock, ket boulders etc.

Artificial Support II

- *Support reinforce rock mass & control bulking.
- *Support retains broken or unstable rock between holding & reinforcement to form stratified arch.
- *Artificial supports are classified by material of construction.
- *Life of support.
- *Rigid or yielding type.
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Brick & Stone Support I

- *Brick or dressed 7 sized stone can be used for support.
- *These materials are used to support / lines shaft, drive by arching.
- *Arching is predominantly used at mine portal.
- *Transportation & use of these material for support are labour intensive.
- *Low cost skilled labour are required to use these material for support.

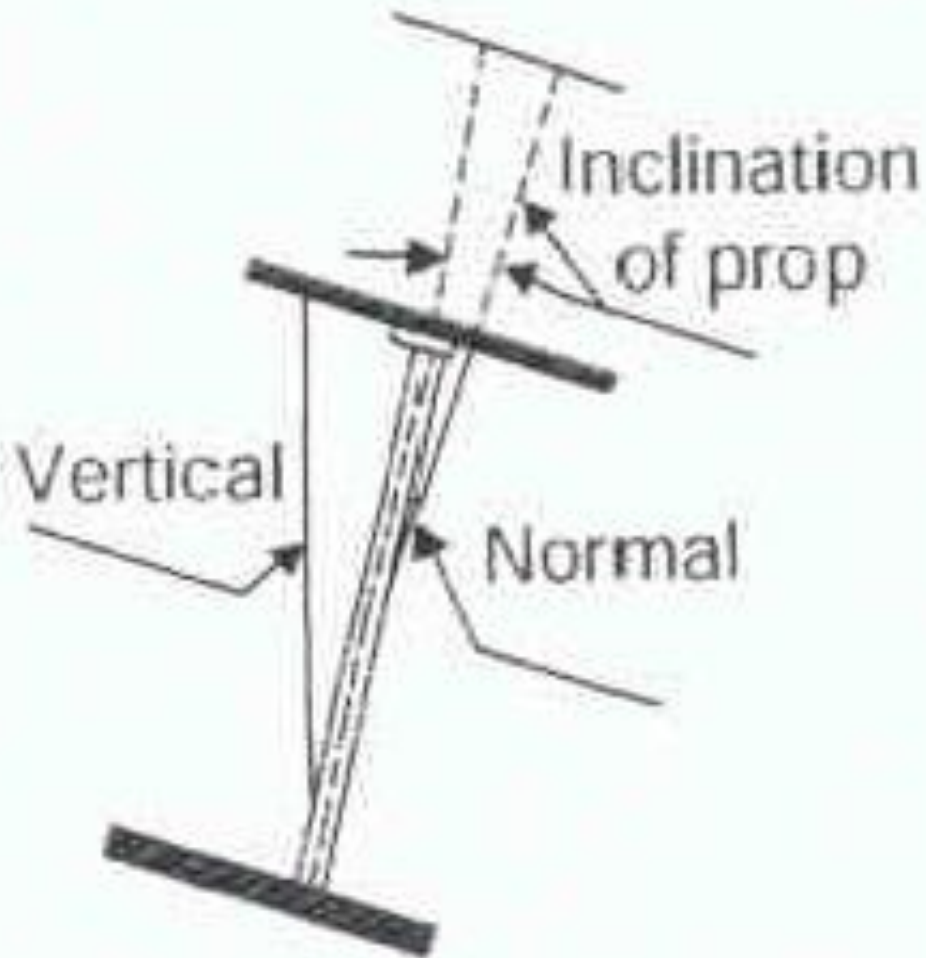
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Timber Support I

- *Locally available wood is used for timber support.
- *“Sal” is widely used, especially at eastern part of India.
- *Sal timber has very tough fiber, generally straight tree & naturally persistent to fungi etc.
- *Timber strength depends on fiber structure.
- *Presence of knot, non-concentric layers, fibers inclination, out side & inside cracks are common defects.
- *These defects further weakens timber.

Wooden Support I

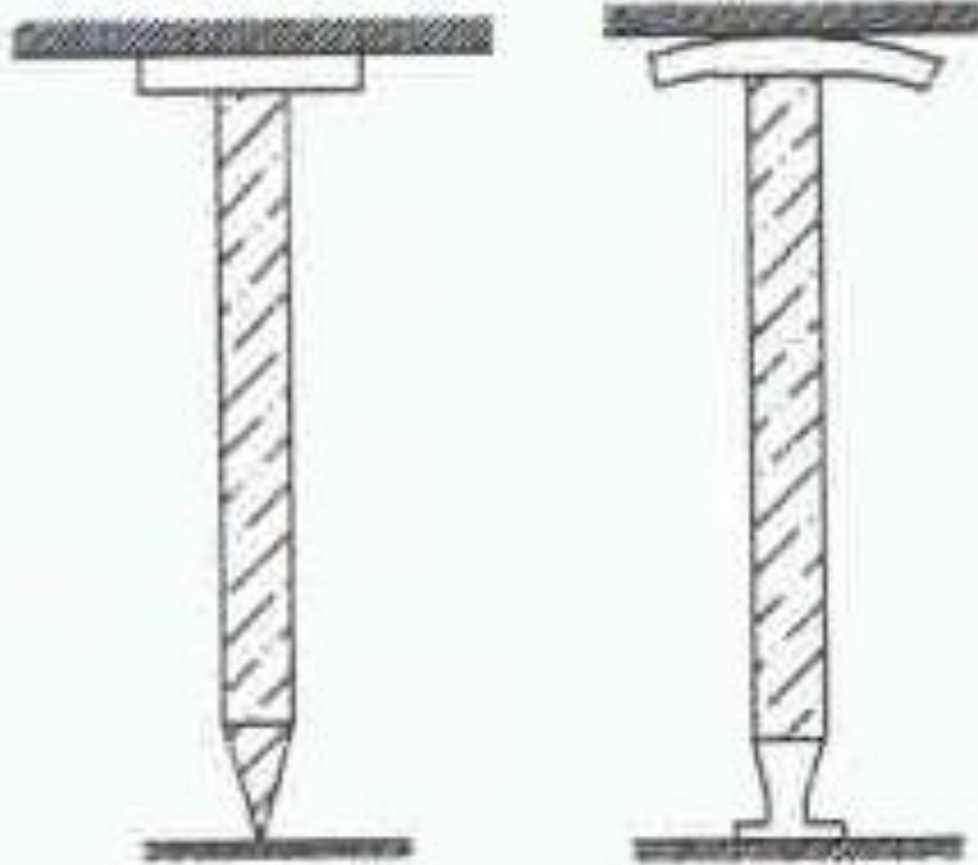
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(a) Wooden prop & its setting

Wooden Support I

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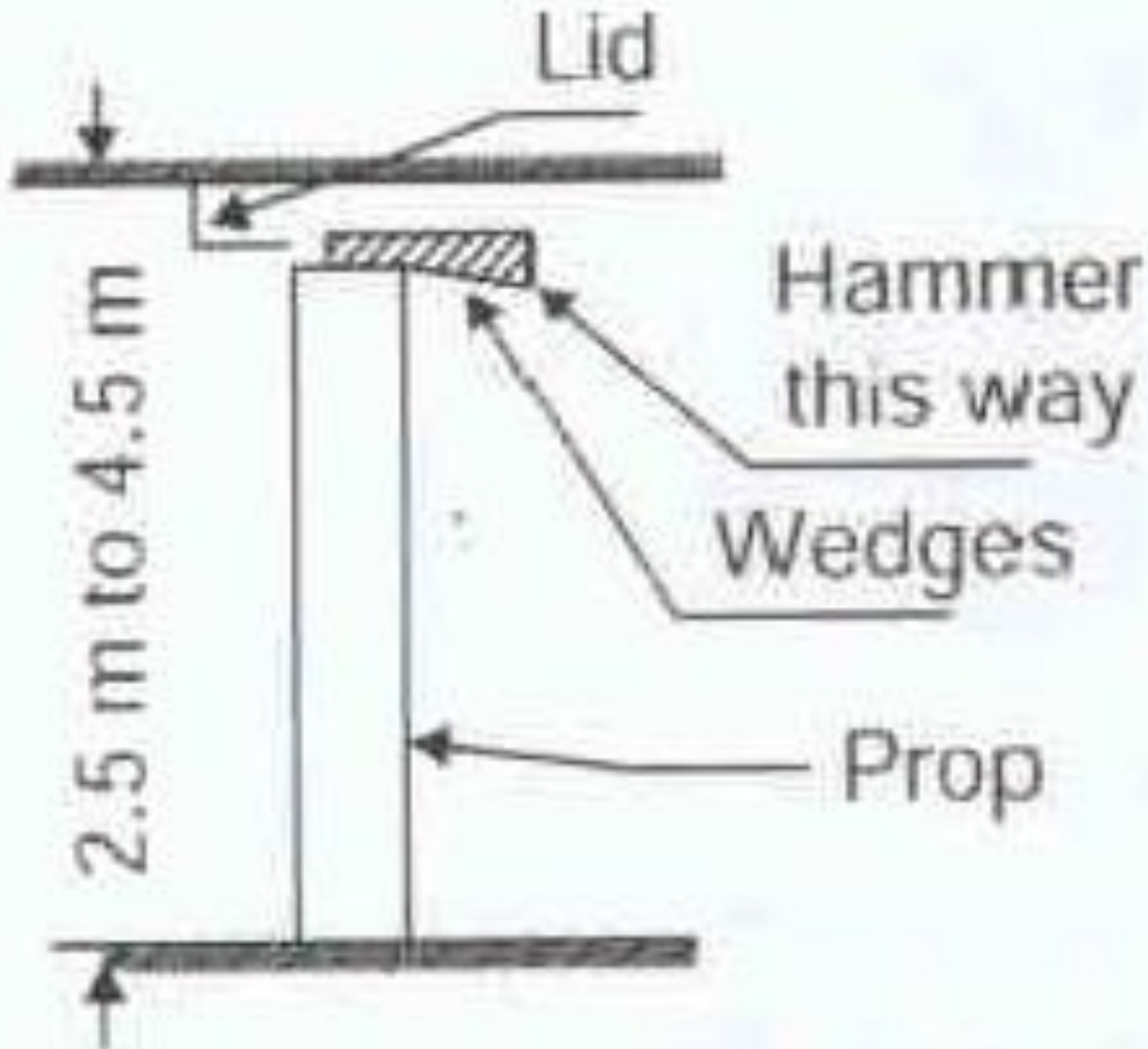


When installed After roof pressure

(b) Tapered prop

Wooden Support I

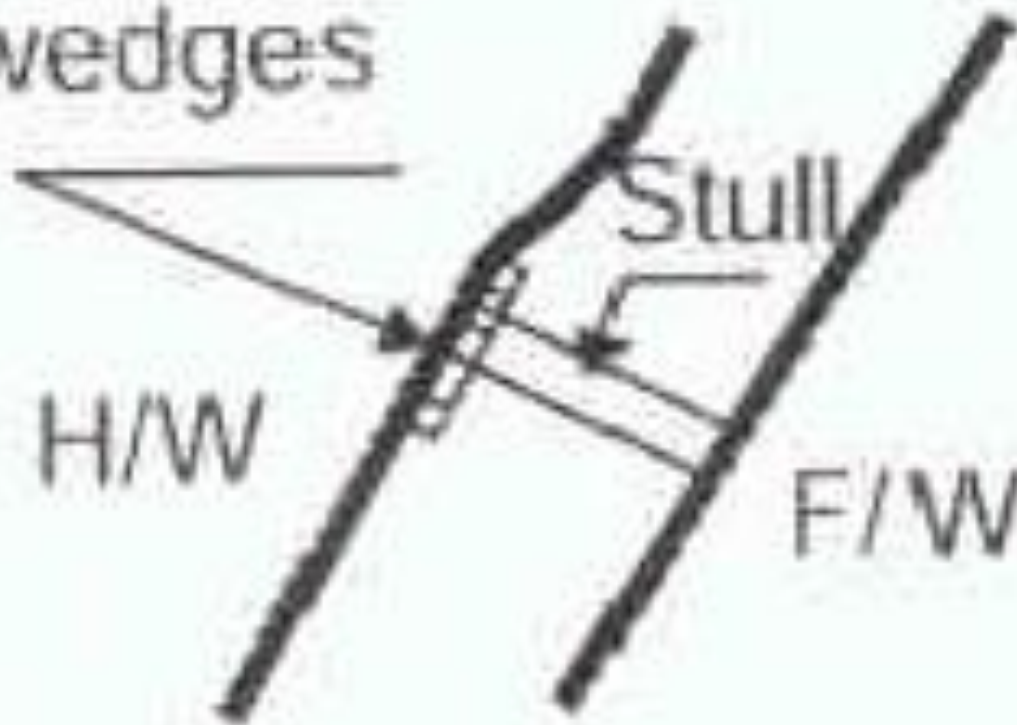
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Timber Support I

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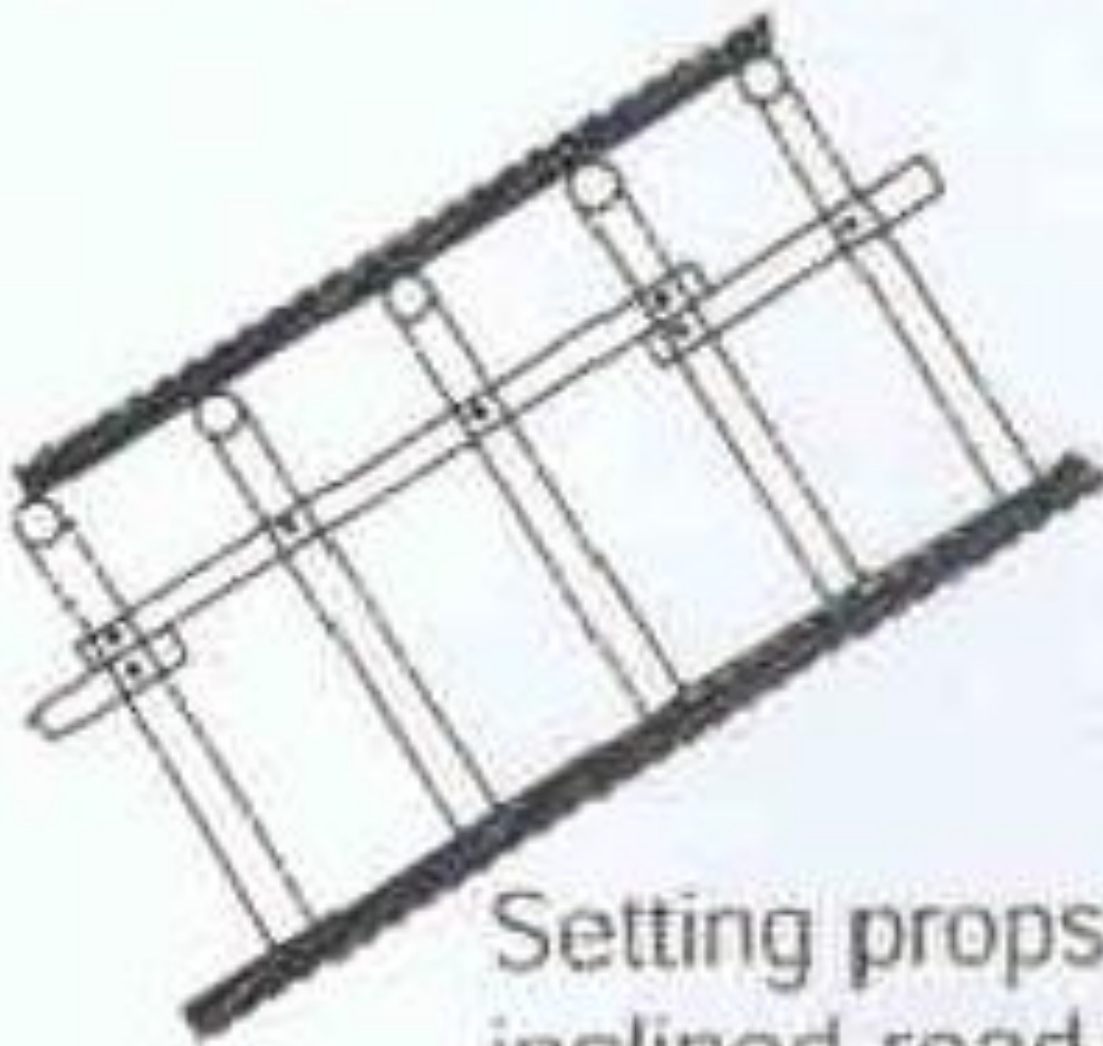
Head boards
& wedges



(c) Round timber stull

Timber Support I

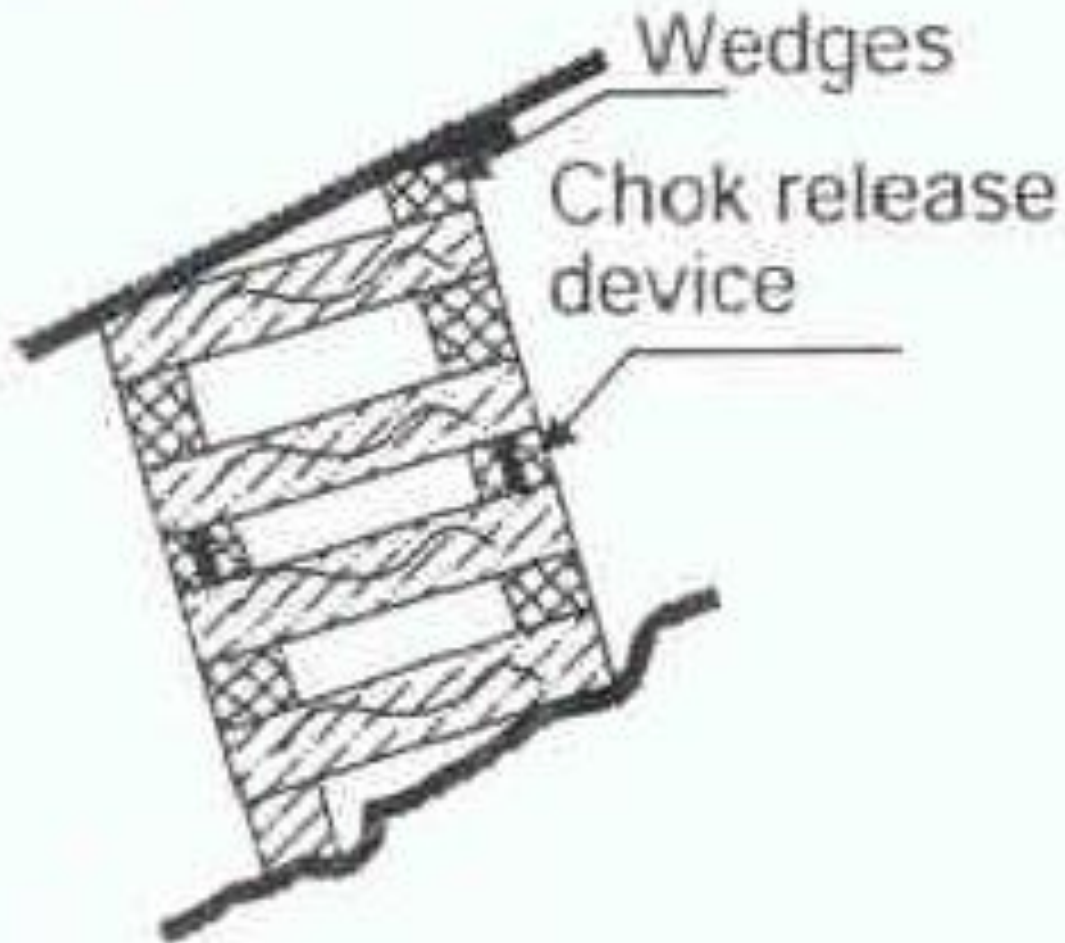
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Setting props in an inclined road-way

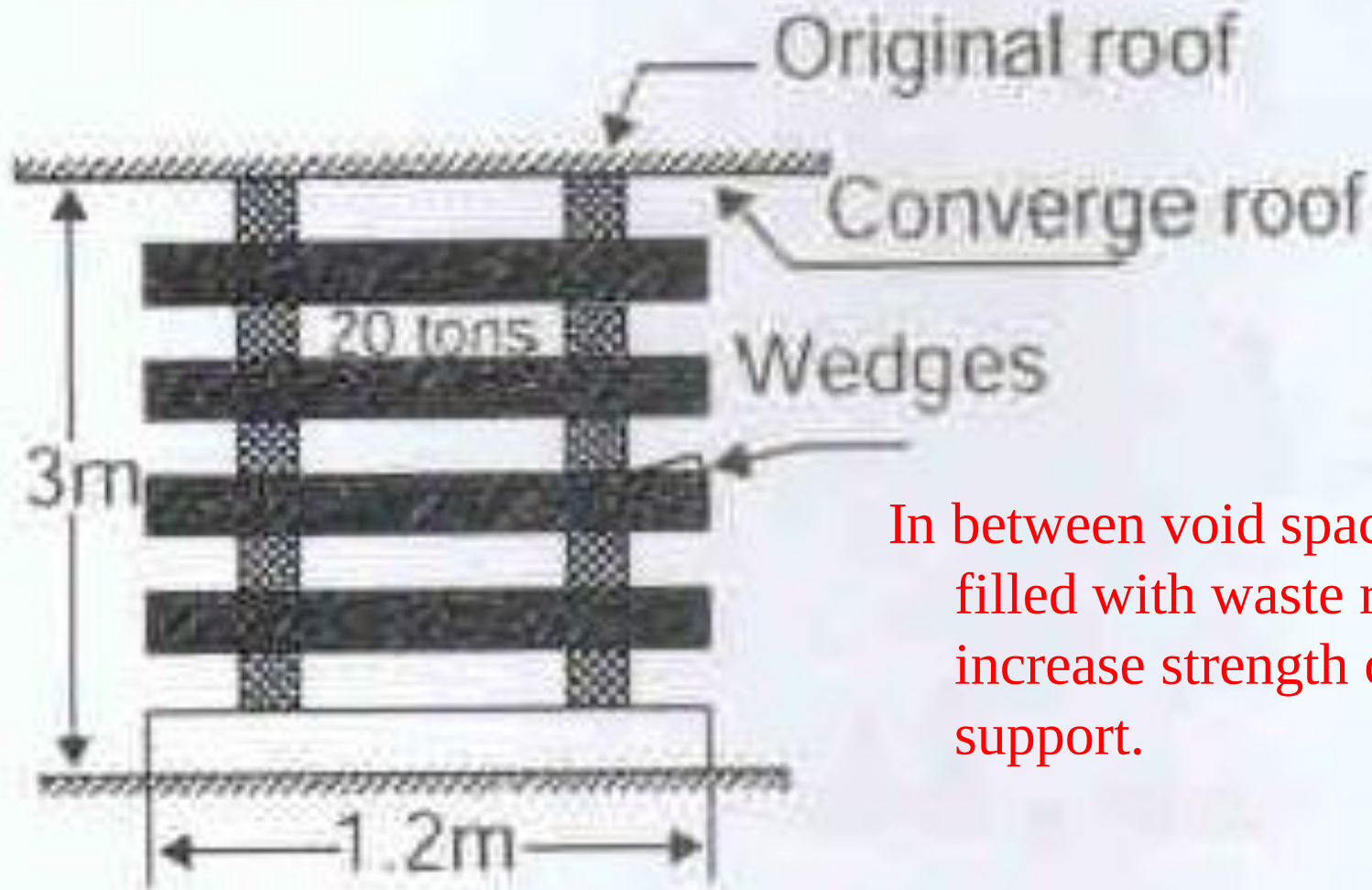
Timber Support I

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(d) Chock in an inclined roadway

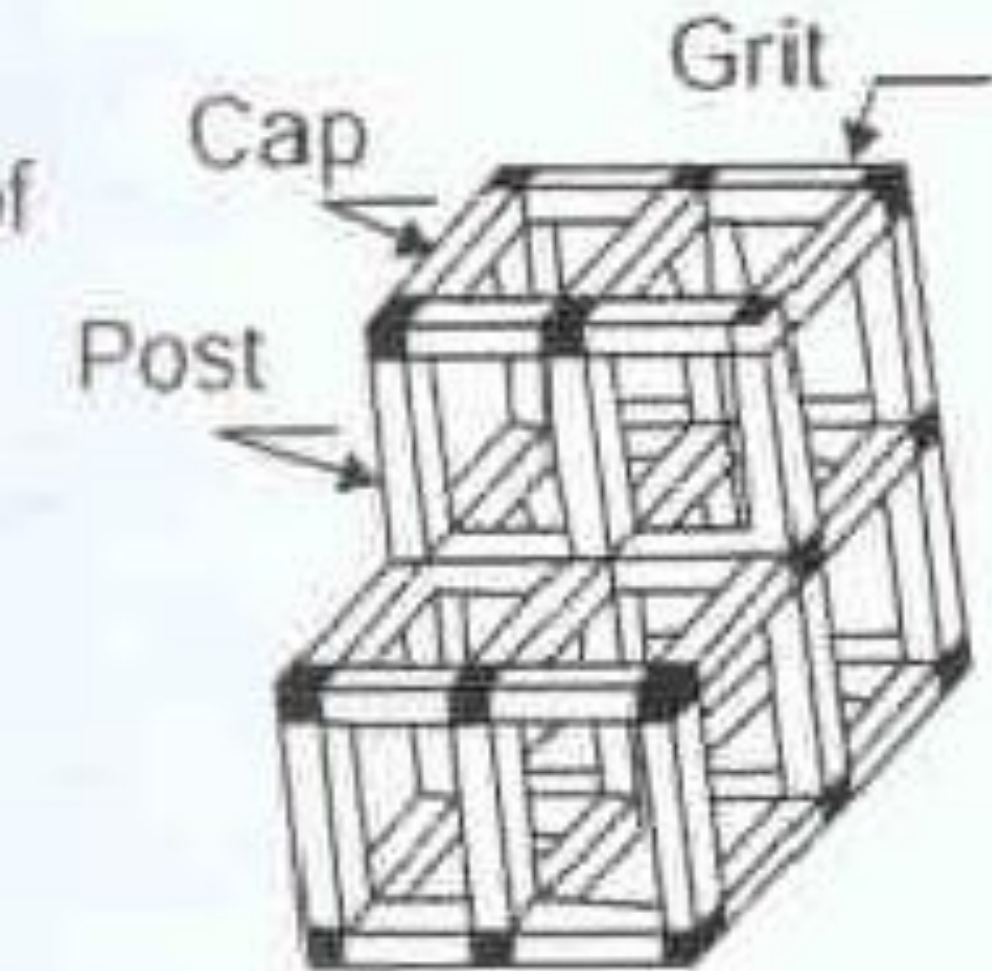
Timber Support I



In between void space can be filled with waste rock to increase strength of support.

(e) Wooden chock

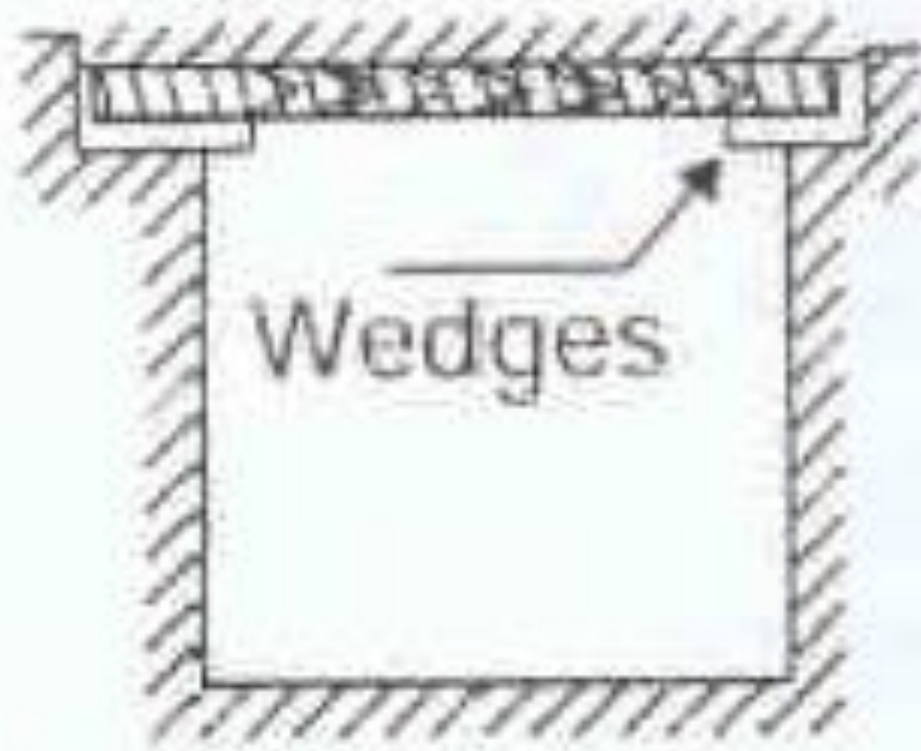
Timber Support I



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(f) Assembly of square set modules

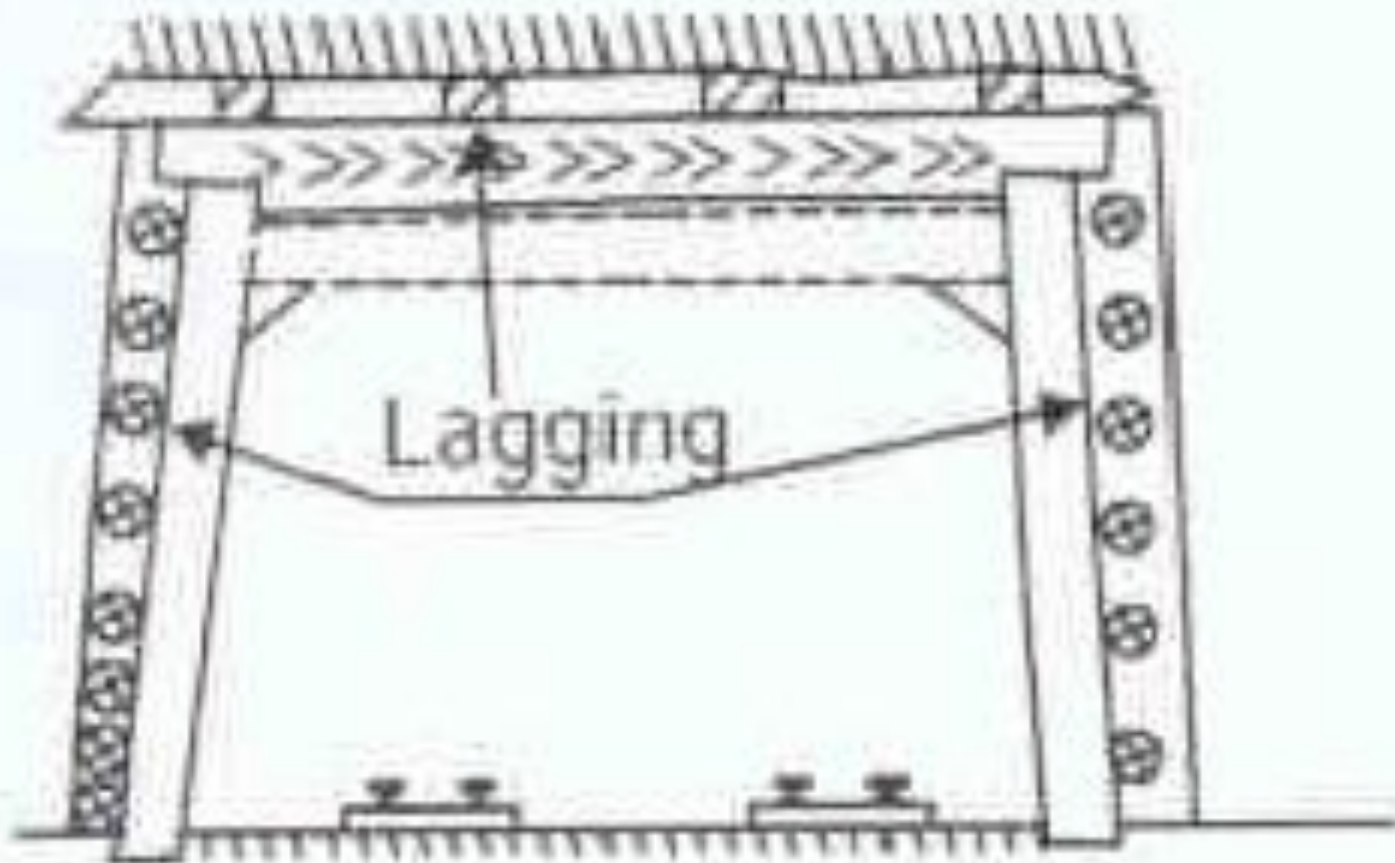
Timber Support I



(g) Wooden bar support

Wooden Support I

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(h) Reinforced timber set

Timber Support II

- *Timber gets effected by funguses, that live in humid condition.
- *Timber is combatable material & needs due precaution against out bust of fire.
- *Freshly cut timber contains above 30% water.
- *Before use, timber needs to be dried (seasoned) by natural drying.
- *After drying, moisture content in timber gets reduced below 20%.
- *Timber has to be made resistant to fungi, bores & insects.

Timber Support III

- *Tar & creosote oil are common organic compounds to season timber.
- *Salt like zinc chloride, copper sulfate, iron sulfate, lime wash are common inorganic treatments for timber.
- *Preservatives are applied by spraying, brushing, cold dipping, hot & cold open tank treatment, pressure tank treatment,
- *At some mines, special treatment is done to make timber fire resistant.
- *Timber is made fire

Timber Support IV

- *Timber is made fire resistant by applying zinc chloride, ferric chloride, boric acid & ammonium phosphate.
- *Timber filled steel pipe, is used as prop (prop stick) South Africa.
- *Timber protrudes from each end of steel tube.
- *Timber acts as axial load bearing member & steel pipe provides lateral constraints, thereby greatly improving yieldability of prop.
- *Pipe stitch is a 150-200 mm diameter wooden prop encased in 3-4mm thick steel pipe.

Timber Support V

- *Timber is flexible & can accommodate large strain before it breaks.

- *Crushing of timber becomes apparent long before it fails.

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Defects of Timber I

Notch



Notch, from where tree branches comes out, also called eye. With time, this portion becomes hollow.

Defects Of Timber I



Unconcentric
layer

Co-centric growth circle indicates uniformity in strength of timber along the cross section. Eccentric growth circle indicate weakness of timber.

Defects of Timber I

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Fiber
inclination

Defects of Timber I

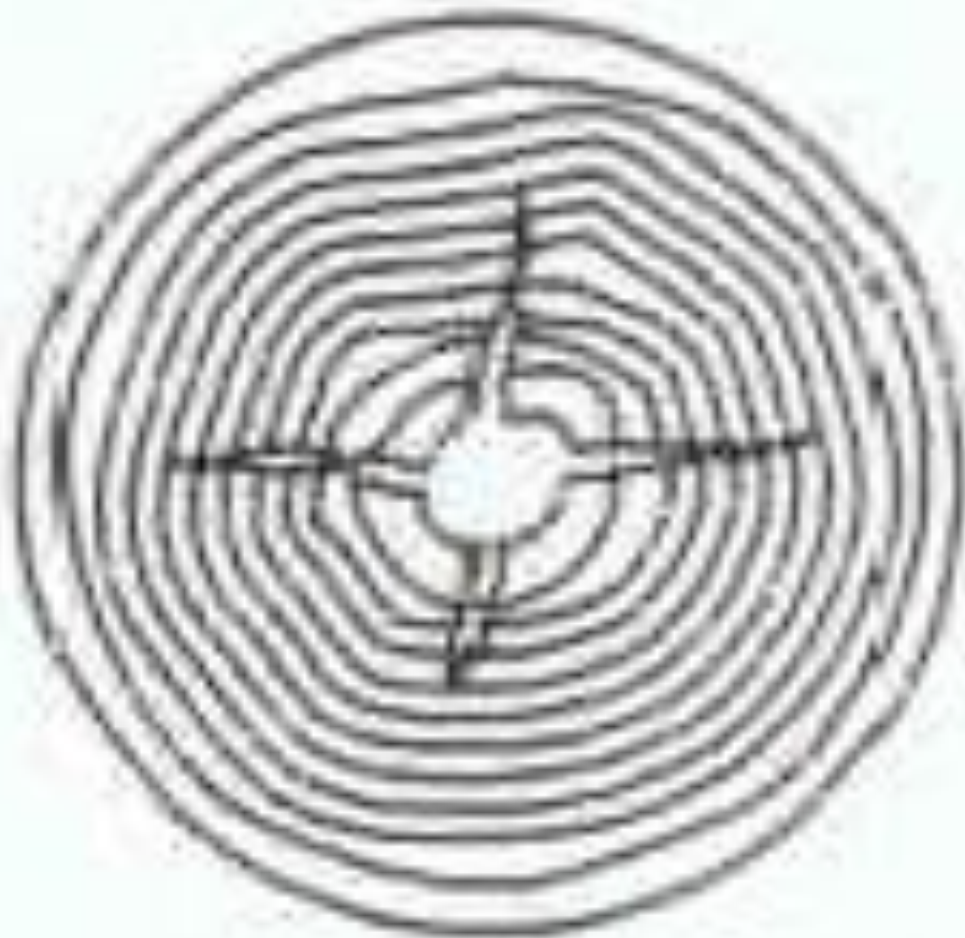
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Outside
crack

Defects Of Timber I

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Inside crack

Wooden Support I

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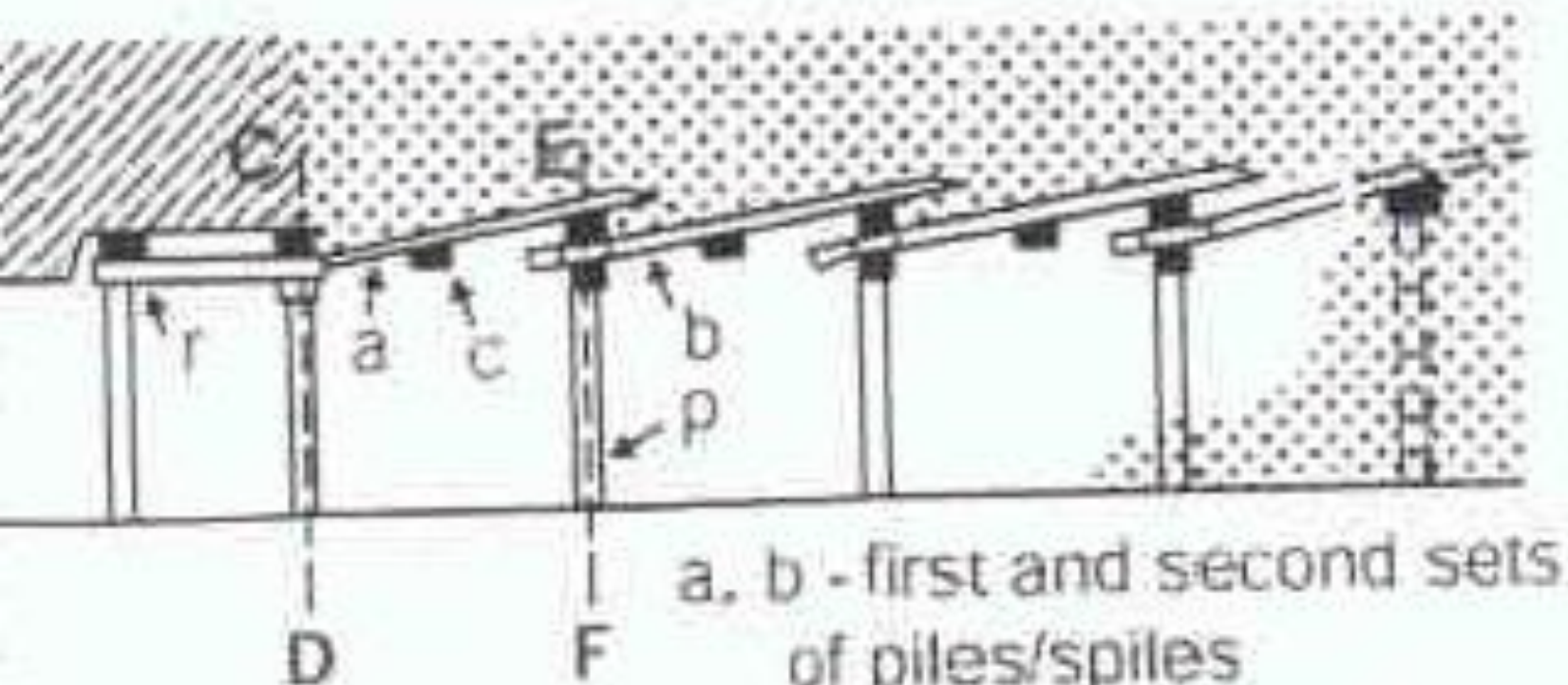
(a) Reinforced timber sets - Different forms



Inclined notch Horizontal notch

Wooden Support I

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a, b - first and second sets
of piles/spiles

c - Bar of full length

r - Runners

p - Prop

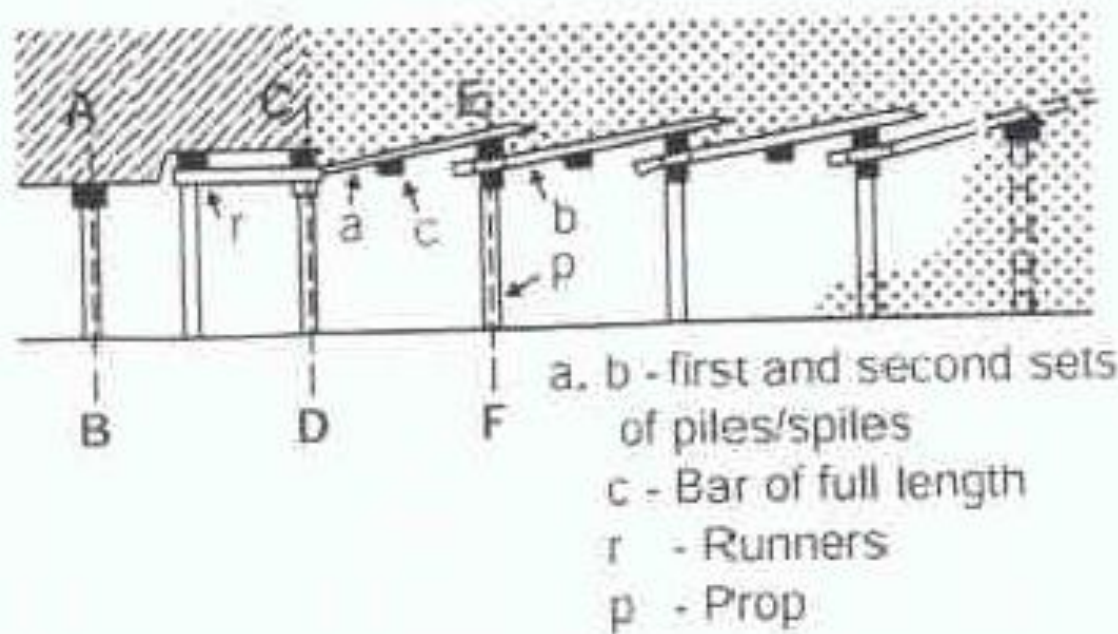
Fore polling*

CD - Roadway in stable ground

Ground and advance support

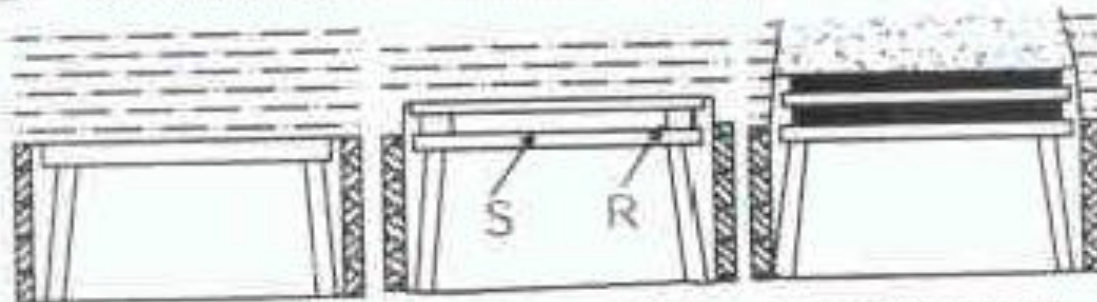
Wooden Support I

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AB, CD - Roadway in stable ground

EF - Ground needs advance support



Section at AB

Section at CD

Section at EF

(c) Advancing by fore - polling

Calculation For Timber Support I

Load bearing capacity of prop

$$P = 47.2 - 1.5 \frac{h}{d}$$

P= load bearing capacity of prop in ton

h= height of prop in mm

d= diameter of prop in mm

Calculation For Timber Support II

Buckling strength of Timber

$$B = \pi^2 E / S^2 \text{ for } S > 100, \quad B = C(1 - aS + bS^2) \text{ for } S < 100$$

$$S = 4l/d$$

B= buckling strength of timber

E=elasticity modules of timber

S=slenderness ratio

a=0 quality constant for mine timber

b=2 quality constant for mine timber

C= crushing strength of timber

l=length of prop in mm

d=diameter of prop in mm

Calculation For Timber Support III

Bending strength (modules of rupture)

$$B_s = M/W, \quad M = Pl/4, \quad W = bh^2/6$$

B_s = bending strength

M = maximum bending movement

W = section modules

P = breaking load

h = height of load in meter

L = length of prop

b = 2, quality constant for mine timber

Calculation For Timber Support IV

Load on wooden gallery

$$h=AL$$

h=height of prop in mm

A=loading factor, depends on rock formation, under normal condition 0.25 – 0.5, for bad roof with cracks 1-2

Calculation For Timber Support V

Pressure on support in t/m sq

$$P_s = h D_r$$

P_s = pressure on support in t/mm sq

H_h = height of prop in mm

D_r = rock density in ton/m sq

Calculation For Timber Support I

Total load produced by parabolic dome per set of support

$$T_L = h L_f L_a D S$$

T_L = total load produced by parabolic dome

h = height of load in meter

L_f = loading factor, depends on rock formation under normal condition 0.25 to 0.5, for bad roof with cracks, it may be 1-2.

L_a = span of drive / gallery

D = rock density

S = distance in between two sets of support

Advantages Of Timber Support I

- *Timber supports are light in weight.
- *Timber can be easily cut, manipulated, transported & out in form of support.
- *Timber can be reused.
- *Timber gives indication before it fails.
- *Timber is best suitable for temporary work.
- *Using timber is economical because of low erection cost & multiple use.

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Disadvantages Of Timber Support I

- *Timber rots in underground humid climate.
- *In dry environment, timber poses' threat of fire in underground, especially in dry hot climate.
- *Availability of good suitable timber is becoming poor.
- *Timber procurement, handling, use etc. have come under stringent law.

Reference I

*Surface and underground Excavations- Methods, Technique and Equipment. Ratan Raj Tatiya, 2005, page 179 to 185.

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